F FOKUS

FROM A LEARNER, FOR LEARNERS

To lower the 90% failure rate of self-initiated learning.

Type any topic, get a learning path sized to it, then work through it one stage at a time. Higher completion, through roadmap-based learning.

THE PROBLEM

Why does this happen?

85–90% of self-initiating learners fail to complete their online learning goals or courses (Mukherjee & Kandiah, 2023). The failure is structural, not a lack of effort.

85–90%

of self-initiating learners never finish what they start

Mukherjee & Kandiah, 2023

The self-paced problem

Nobody is waiting for you. There is no next step scheduled, so the week you get busy is the week it ends.

No gentle entry

Beginners meet the hardest material first, because search ranks popularity, not order. Then they assume they cannot do it.

How can we lower this fail rate? Give the learner an order they can follow, and a way to know it landed.

WHAT HAPPENS WITHOUT A PATH

Searches the topic

The first step is a search box with no order to it.

Opens a dozen tabs

Articles, videos, a paid course, three Reddit threads.

Starts with the longest

Length feels like rigour, so the hardest thing comes first.

Stops

No schedule, no check, no next step. The tab closes.

WHO IS AFFECTED?

Our market, to start.

Two segments, same job: they have already decided to learn something and have no structure for it.

University student

Studies outside coursework, on a laptop and a phone, around deadlines.

Issue: lack of accountability, study burnout.

Young adult

Learning a skill for work or a hobby, in short sessions after hours.

Issue: distraction from existing work and responsibilities.

2

segments in scope for the beta

1

job to be done: topic in, usable order out

0

new habits required of the learner

Segment split follows the types-of-learners findings summarised from Pepperdine University, DigitalDefynd and the World Economic Forum. We are not quoting a market size we cannot defend; the beta measures our own conversion.

THE TREND FROM NOW

The easy answer is already in their hands.

AI use among students is not a future trend, it is the default. Reports from KPMG, FrontiersIn and the Journal of Nusantara Studies (JONUS) point the same direction, and the newest numbers are large.

83%

of students use AI in their studies regularly, half of them weekly or daily

KPMG global student survey, data Nov 2024 – Jan 2025

68%

use AI specifically to complete coursework assignments (n=119, Malaysian university)

Sunway University study, ACM, 2023

89%

of students use free public AI tools rather than ones their institution provides

KPMG, same survey

What that means

The habit is already formed, and it is formed around getting the answer, not learning the material. Anyone building learning tools now competes with a chatbot that answers instantly.

What it opens

Students do not need to be convinced to use AI for study. They need it pointed at completion instead of answers. That is a positioning problem we can win.

Sources: KPMG, *Trust, attitudes and use of artificial intelligence* (global student survey, fieldwork Nov 2024 – Jan 2025). Sunway University / ACM, *Beyond the Textbook: ChatGPT patterns of use among students in higher education*, 2023, n=119. Nasidi et al., *Factors influencing AI adoption among Malaysian students*, Journal of Nusantara Studies 10(2), 475–493, 2025, n=224.

SCENARIO: “EASY WAY OUT”

Are they really learning?

WHAT HAPPENS NOW

Paste the assignment, take the answer, submit it. Thirty seconds, no friction, nothing retained.

The work is completed. The learner is not.

vs

WHAT FOKUS DOES DIFFERENTLY

The path is ordered, the module ends in three questions, and the next module waits until you pass.

Same AI, pointed at retrieval instead of output.

It answers

A chatbot gives you the thing you asked for and ends there.

It asks back

Every module has a check, so you cannot skip past what you did not absorb.

It remembers

Progress, next module and completion live in the account, not in a chat log.

3–5
questions, drawn from that stage's own guide and sized to it

⅔
correct to unlock the next stage

1
explanation per answer, right or wrong

0
way to skip a check you have not passed

THE SOLUTION

Better with a map.

A path of stages in order, each stage worked through step by step, progress kept. The path is the interface: you always know where you are and what is next.

Why: an accessible, simple UI

One input, one path, one next step. No dashboards to configure, no playlists to curate, no options before the first module opens. It works on a phone in one hand.

Why: to ensure it actually landed

Each stage ends with a check written from that stage's own guide: recall, applying the idea, and the mistake beginners make. Two thirds right and the next stage unlocks, so completion means comprehension rather than exposure.

5–12
stages per path, sized to the topic rather than a fixed eight

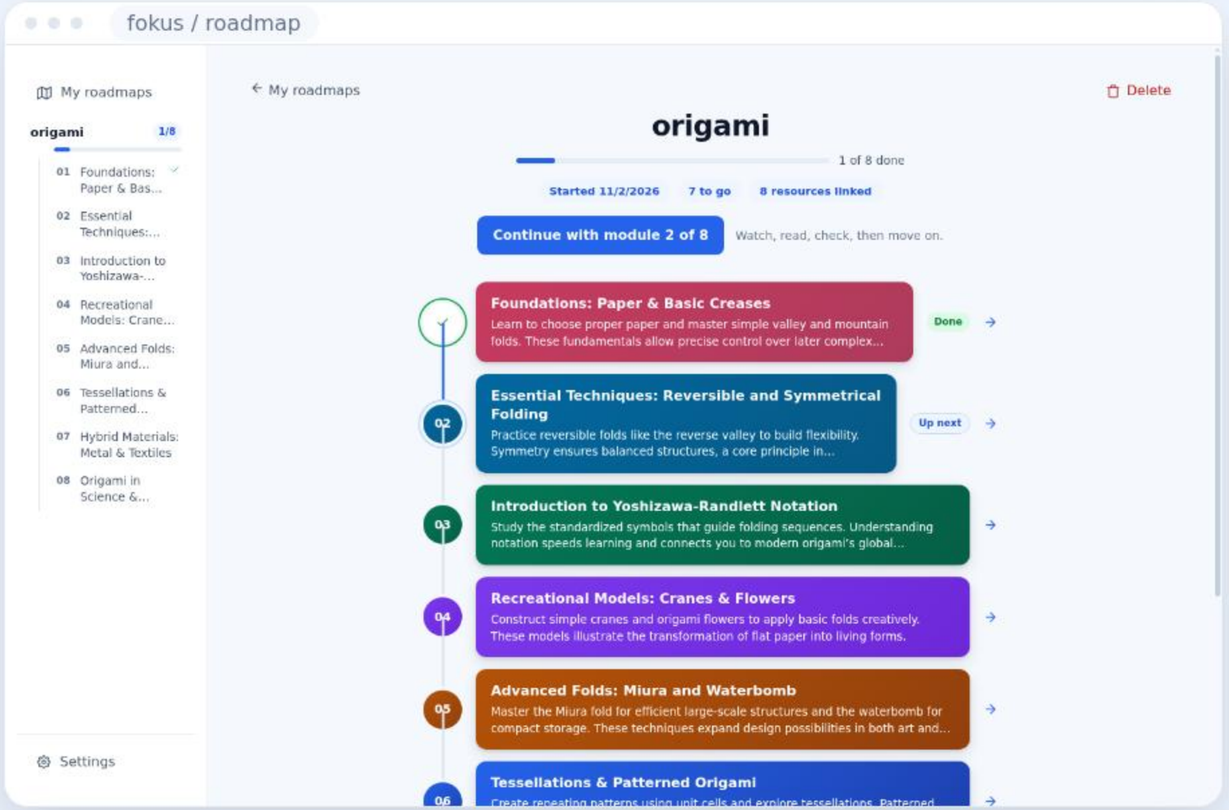
3+
steps per stage: watch, read, check, go deeper

3–5
questions per check, set by what the guide covered

⅔
of them right to unlock the next stage

THE PRODUCT

A real roadmap, on a real account.



Numbered, not endless

A finite set of stages in a fixed order, with the one you are on marked.

Checked, not assumed

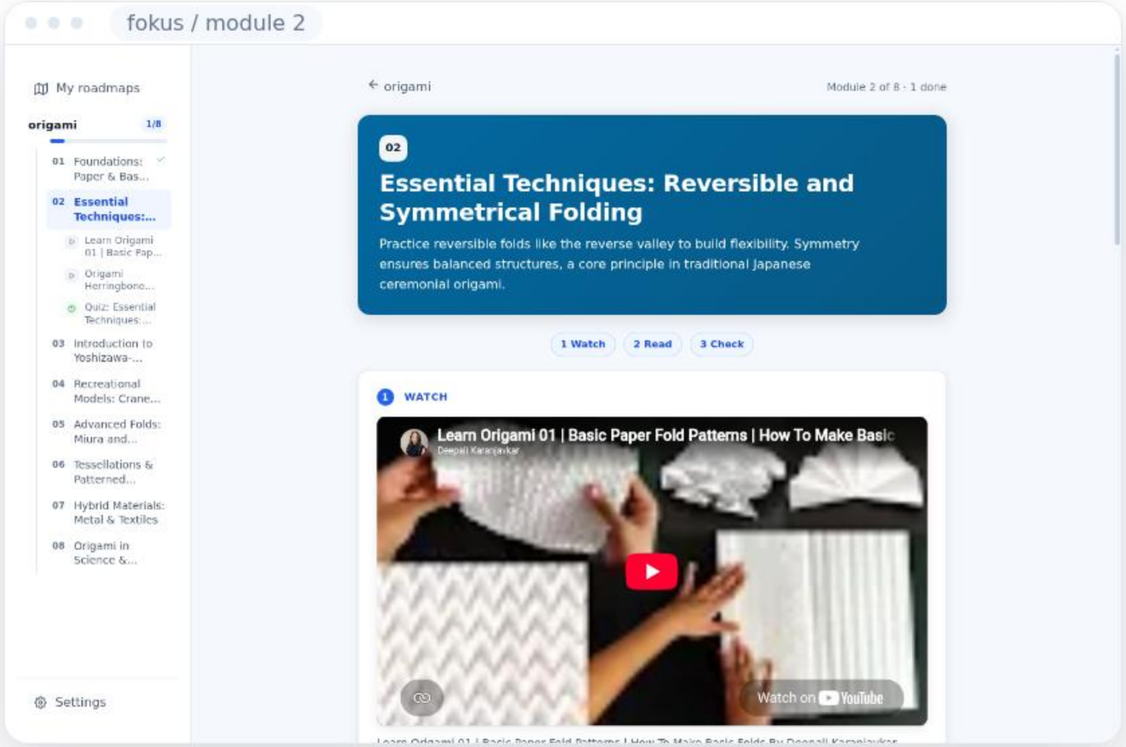
The check decides when the next stage opens.

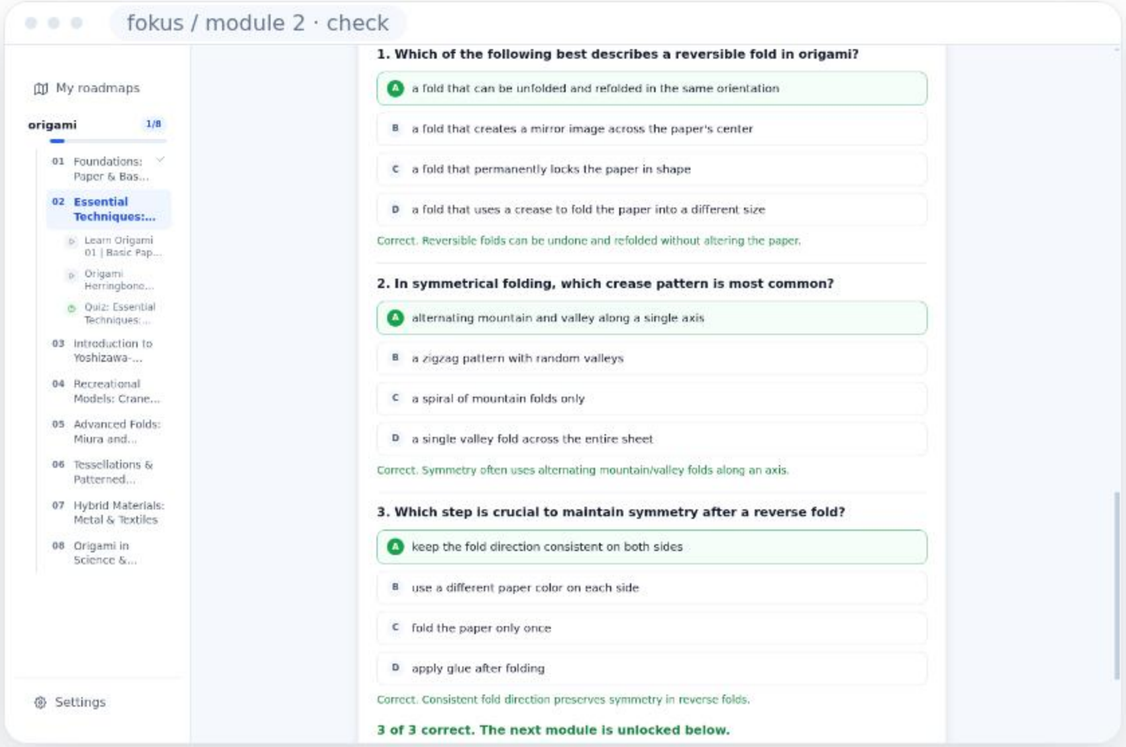
Kept, not lost

Progress per account, and any roadmap can be saved to the device for offline reading.

INSIDE A MODULE

Watch, read, check. Then move on.





1 Watch

Real videos for this stage.

2 Read

A guide with sources.

3 Check

Targeted questions, instant.

THE PRODUCT IN CODE

One request, five steps, nothing invented.

Recommendations are real: videos are scraped from YouTube search and verified, courses are platform search links. No fabricated titles, ids or badges.

LEARNER

Types a topic

A gate blocks key-spam and non-learnable input before any model call.

SYSTEM

Researches

Pulls live Wikipedia sources for the topic, and per module when it opens.

MODEL

Writes the stages

Between 5 and 12, chosen from the topic's real scope. Ordered beginner to advanced.

SYSTEM

Finds resources

Real YouTube results, verified; course search links per platform.

MODEL

Builds the check

3 to 5 targeted questions per stage, from that stage's guide. Stored once.

~2.4s
to generate a whole path

2.5s
to write one stage guide, then cached

1
model call per artefact, never repeated

0
fabricated videos or links, verified at source

BUSINESS MODEL

Priced under what students already pay.

FREE

RM0

for trying it properly

- One active roadmap
- All 8 modules and checks
- Progress saved to the account
- Offline copy of that roadmap

PLUS

RM12 / month

for the student with three topics on the go

- Unlimited roadmaps
- Offline copies of all of them
- Priority generation when busy
- Export a roadmap as a document

COHORT

RM6 / seat / month

10 seats minimum, for a class or study group

- Shared roadmaps and a join code
- Per-module completion view
- One invoice, one owner

ChatGPT+ RM90/month **Notion RM51/month** Plus sits at **13%** of the ChatGPT+ benchmark and **24%** of Notion, for one job rather than a general tool.

Unit economics

A new roadmap costs about **RM0.003** of inference. A roadmap taken all the way through, eight guides and eight quizzes, costs about **RM0.03**.

Groq gpt-oss-20b at $0.075 / $0.30 per million tokens, converted at 4.07 MYR/USD, measured against the app's own token limits.

Why it holds

A heavy Plus user finishing 20 roadmaps a month costs about **RM0.62** to serve, against RM12 of revenue.

A free user on one active roadmap costs at most RM0.03 and is capped by design. Paid tiers also remove the free-tier daily token ceiling that limits the instance today.

WHERE THIS GOES

One engine, four audiences, in order.

Each stage reuses the same topic-in, path-out core. We move when the stage before it works for its users.

NOW	**Students teaching themselves** One person, one topic, one account, offline copies.	Shipping
NEXT	**Study groups and small cohorts** Shared roadmaps, a join code, who is on which module.	After beta feedback
LATER	**Classrooms and trainers** Instructor-authored paths, deadlines, per-module reporting.	Needs instructor accounts
LATER	**Institutions** Faculty deployment, SSO, content review before a path reaches students.	Needs the stage above proven

Not a mockup. A working account-based app.

Learner side

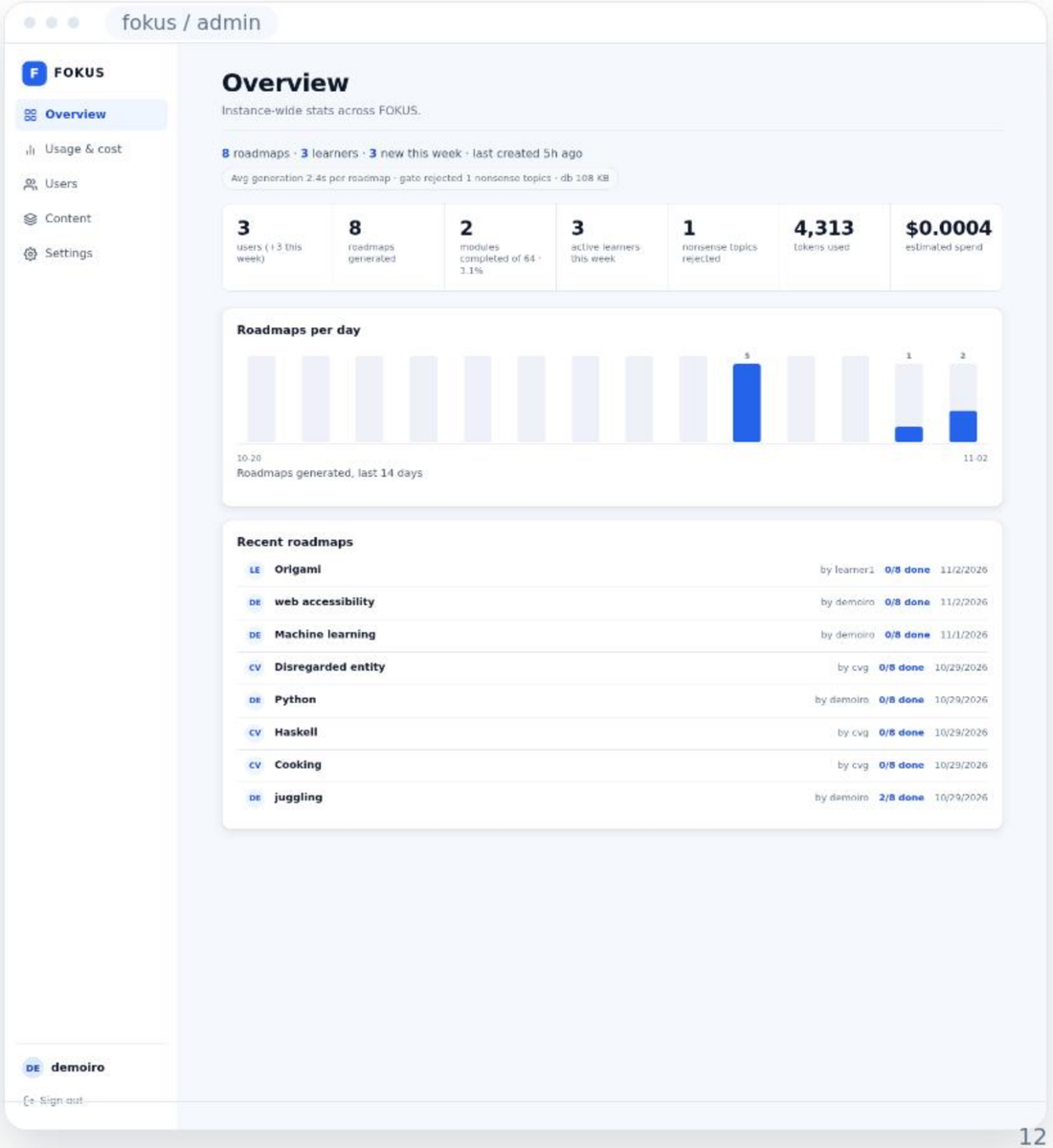
- Accounts, saved roadmaps, progress
- Course sidebar with the module tree
- Watch, read, check per module
- Offline copies

Operator side

- Usage, tokens and cost
- Users and their roadmaps
- Content list and progress
- Refusals and rate limits

Also shipped

Installable as a phone app, an Android build on the repo, and a public landing page that shows a real roadmap building itself.



WHAT WE KNOW IS MISSING

The honest limit list.

A pitch that hides its constraints gets caught in the first question. Each of these has a next step.

Capacity

On the free model tier the instance caps out around six fully explored roadmaps a day. A paid key removes that ceiling and is the first spend the beta needs.

Retention evidence

No cohort data yet. Fifteen completions is a signal that the loop works, not proof that people come back for module nine on a new topic.

Surface area

No sharing, no groups, no instructor tools. Every roadmap is personal-only today, which is what the Cohort tier has to change.

Distribution

Hosted on a personal tunnel. A real domain and a managed host are required before any public beta link goes out.

THE ASK

Ten students, one topic each, one honest list of what broke.

1

Run a closed beta

Ten self-study students make a roadmap on a topic they already know, then open module one and take its check.

2

Fix the first run

Everything the beta breaks gets fixed before the next wave. No recruiting everyone at once.

3

Then the next tier

With the loop steady, add shared roadmaps for cohorts, and only then classroom features.

Live demo: gateway-hermes.tail62f36e.ts.net/fokus

Android build on the repo releases

The ask is five minutes per tester: one topic they already know, module one, and a sentence on where it confused them.